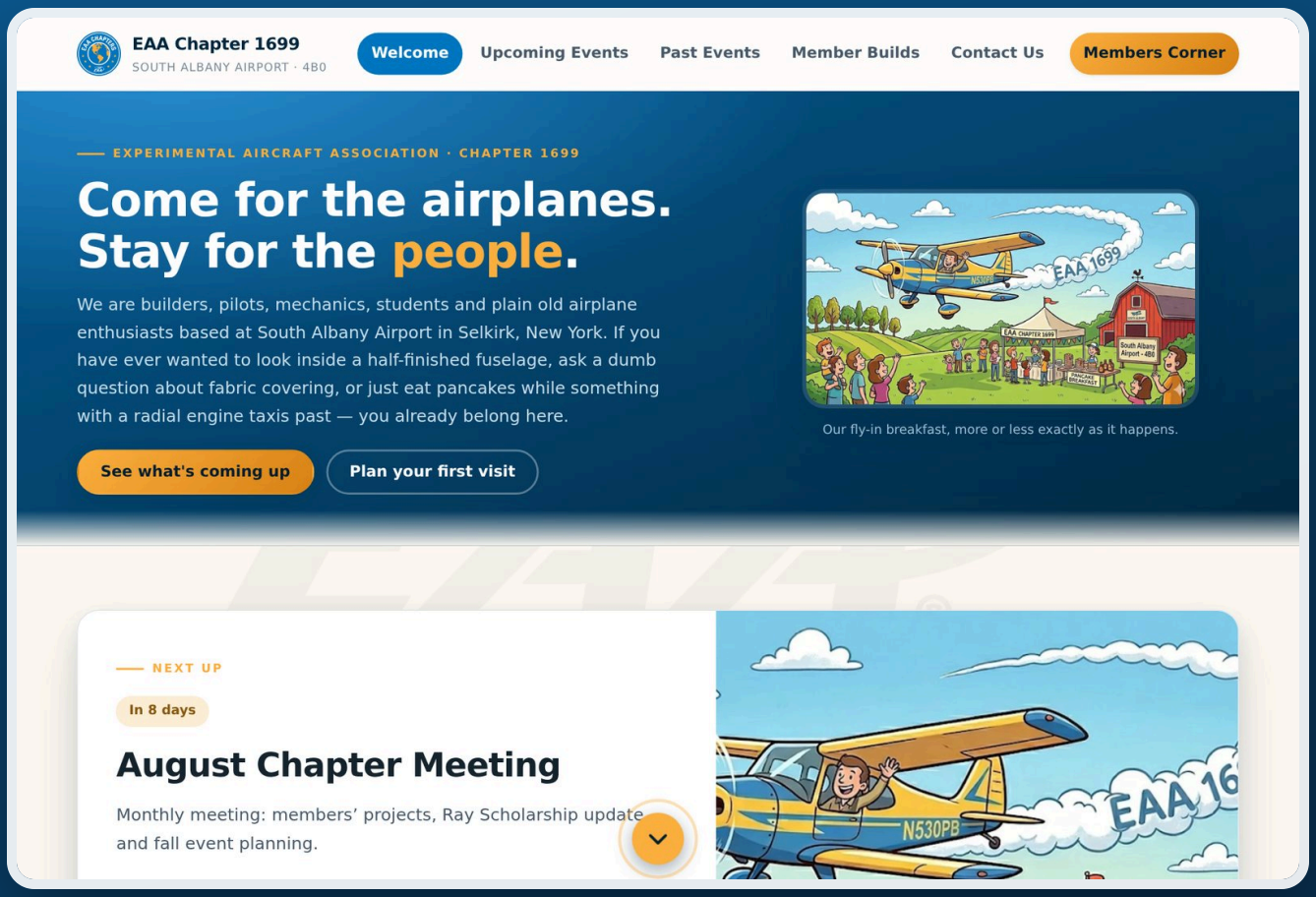
EAA CHAPTER 1699 · SOUTH ALBANY AIRPORT (4B0)

Cleared for Takeoff.

The friendly, no-jargon guide to the chapter website — for members, editors and admins. No type rating required.



Members

Borrow tools, log your build, read the blog

Editors

Write posts, run the calendar, answer the inbox

Admins

Let people in, hand out keys, keep the lights on

BEFORE WE START THE ENGINE

Welcome aboard

Our chapter website does two jobs. On the outside it's the chapter's front porch: anyone can see upcoming events, look at photos from past fly-ins, and follow along with members' build projects. On the inside, behind a sign-in, is the **Members Corner** — a clubhouse where we lend each other tools, keep build logs, write up meetings and find each other's phone numbers.

This guide walks you through all of it, in plain English. You do not need to know anything about computers beyond "click the orange button." If you can preflight an airplane, you can run this website — and it's far less likely to have a mouse nest in it.

Pick your seat

Everyone who signs in has one of three **roles**. Each role can do everything the one before it can, plus a bit more. Think of it like moving from the back seat, to the right seat, to the left seat.

BACK SEAT

Member

- Read and comment on the blog
- List tools and borrow other people's
- Keep a build log for your project
- Use the member directory
- Manage your own account

RIGHT SEAT

Editor

- *Everything a member can do, plus…*
- Write and edit blog posts
- Tidy up comments
- Run the events calendar
- Answer the public Contact Us inbox

LEFT SEAT

Admin

- *Everything an editor can do, plus…*
- Approve new member requests
- Invite people, change roles, suspend
- Watch the automatic emails
- See site stats and the activity log

✈ Not sure which seat you're in?

Your account page (click your name, top right) shows **Your role**. Or check the blue bar: **Events** and **Inbox** links mean **editor**; an orange **☰ Admin tools** button means **admin**.

How this guide is laid out

Preflight

The public website, getting an account, signing in. Everyone should read this bit.

Part 1 — Members

The dashboard, blog, Tool Locker, build logs, directory, documents and your account.

Part 2 — Editors

Writing posts, running events, and answering the Contact Us inbox.

Part 3 — Admins

Membership requests, people, automatic emails, stats and the log.

Part 4 & Appendix

How to share ideas and report problems (it's your site!), plus a cheat sheet, troubleshooting and a glossary.

Look out for orange ☕ **Hangar talk** boxes along the way: Saturday-morning coffee stories. Screenshot people are made-up demo members; all emails and phone numbers are fake.

PREFLIGHT · FOR EVERYONE

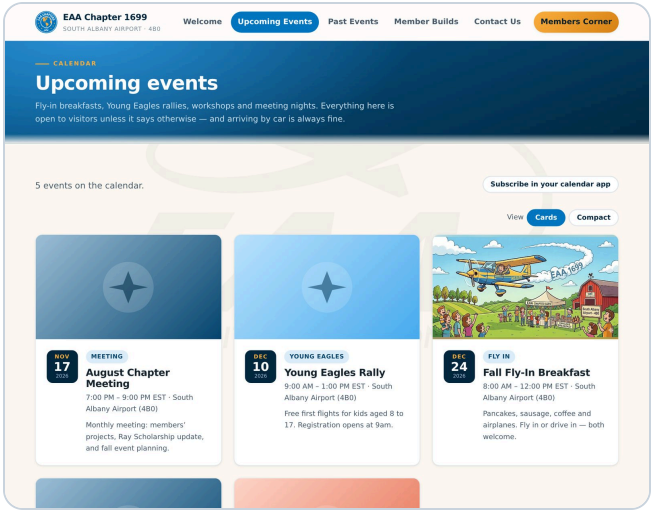
Walkaround

Before we climb in, a lap around the outside. This is the part of the site anyone on the internet can see, plus how to get the keys.

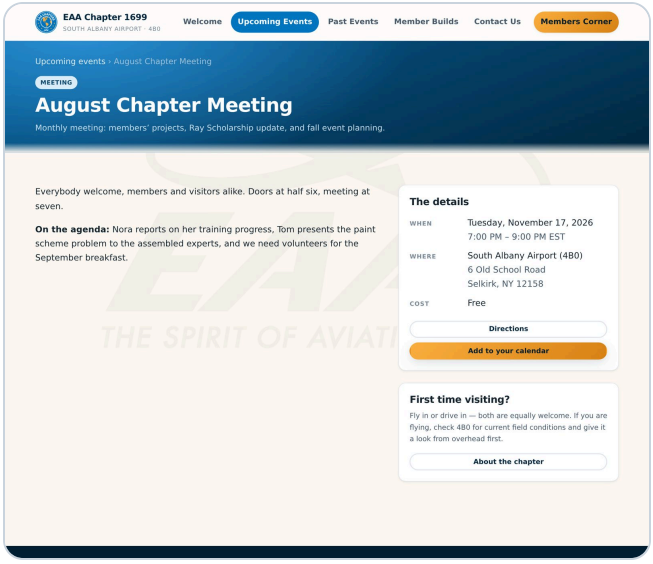
No sign-in needed

The public website

Across the top of every page is the main menu: **Welcome**, **Upcoming Events**, **Past Events**, **Member Builds**, **Contact Us**, and an orange **Members Corner** button on the right. Everything except the Members Corner is public — it's what your neighbor sees when they search for "airplane pancakes Selkirk."

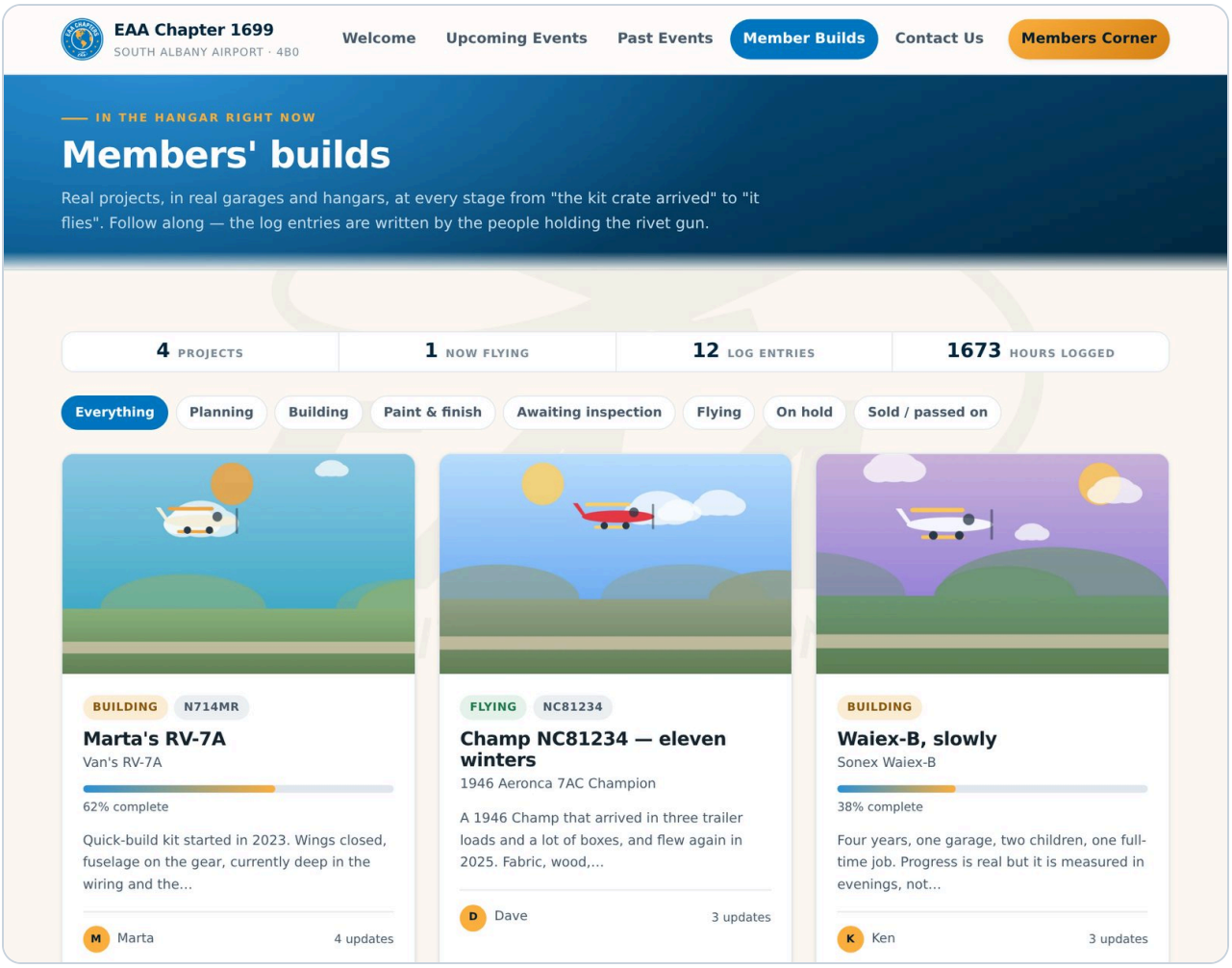


Upcoming Events — every fly-in, meeting and Young Eagles day.



One event, with the date, place, cost, directions and an "Add to your calendar" button.

- **Upcoming Events** lists what's coming. Click any event for the details, a **Directions** button, and **Add to your calendar**.
- **Subscribe in your calendar app** (top right of the events page) adds the *whole* chapter calendar to Google, Outlook, Apple Calendar or ForeFlight. New events appear by themselves. It's the single best button on the site for people who forget meetings. (You know who you are.)
- **Past Events** is the scrapbook: photos and a short write-up of how each event went.
- **Member Builds** shows the projects members are building — progress bars, hours logged and dated diary entries.
- **Contact Us** sends a message to the chapter. A real person (an editor) reads it and replies from the chapter's email address.



Members' builds — the chapter's actual work, out in the open for anyone to follow.

> ☕ **Hangar talk**
> *Why are build logs public? Because "come see a half-finished airplane in a garage" turns out to be the best recruiting pitch a chapter has. More than one person has found us by following someone's build online, and then turned up at a meeting asking, "Is Ken's tail done yet?" (It is not. It's measured in evenings, not weekends.)*

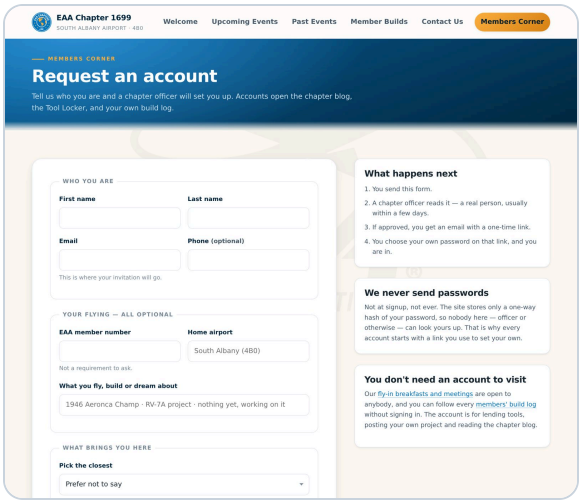
Getting an account

You can't just sign up and walk in — an admin looks at every request first. It's a bit like a hangar door: friendly, but somebody has the key. Here's how it works:

1. Click **Members Corner**, then the link to **request an account** (or go straight to the **/join** page).
2. Fill in your name, email and a few sentences about yourself. Your EAA number, home airport and what you fly are optional — you don't need to be a pilot. Truly. Some of our best members are "a parent whose kid won't stop talking about airplanes."

3. Press send. An admin gets a note and will look at it, usually within a few days.
4. If approved, you'll get an **invitation email** with a one-time link.
5. Click the link and **choose your own password**. You're in!

> **✈ Good to know**
>
> Nobody — not even an admin — ever picks your password or can see it. The site only keeps a scrambled "fingerprint" of it. That's why every account starts with a link instead of a password.
>
> The invitation link is good for 14 days. If it expires, ask an admin to press **Re-invite**.

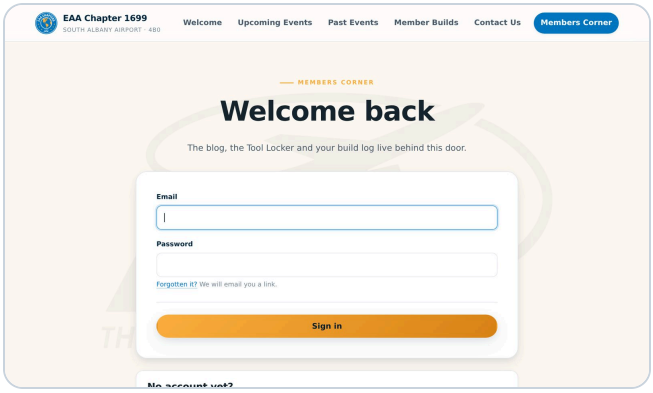


The "Request an account" form.

Signing in (and out)

Click **Members Corner** on any page. Type your email and password and press **Sign in**.

- **Forgot your password?** Click **Forgotten it?** under the password box. We'll email you a link to set a new one. The link works once and expires after an hour, so don't leave it in your inbox overnight.
- **Passwords need at least 12 characters.** A short sentence works great: *"my champ needs new fabric"* is far harder to guess than *"P@ssw0rd1"*, and much easier to remember.
- **Too many wrong guesses** (eight in a row) locks the account for 15 minutes. Go get a coffee, then try again — or use **Forgotten it?**.
- **Signing out:** click **Sign out** at the right-hand end of the blue members bar. You'll also be signed out automatically after about 12 hours.



The sign-in page. That's it. No CAPTCHA asking you to find the traffic lights.

> **☕ Hangar talk**
>
> *A member once tried every password he'd ever owned, including the one for his 1998 AOL account, and locked himself out. Fifteen minutes and one cup of coffee later he used "Forgotten it?" and was back in in under a minute. Moral: the reset link is faster than your memory. Use it early.*

PART 1 · MEMBERS

The Members Corner

Your clubhouse. Everything here is visible only to signed-in chapter members. This part applies to everyone — editors and admins too.

Back seat

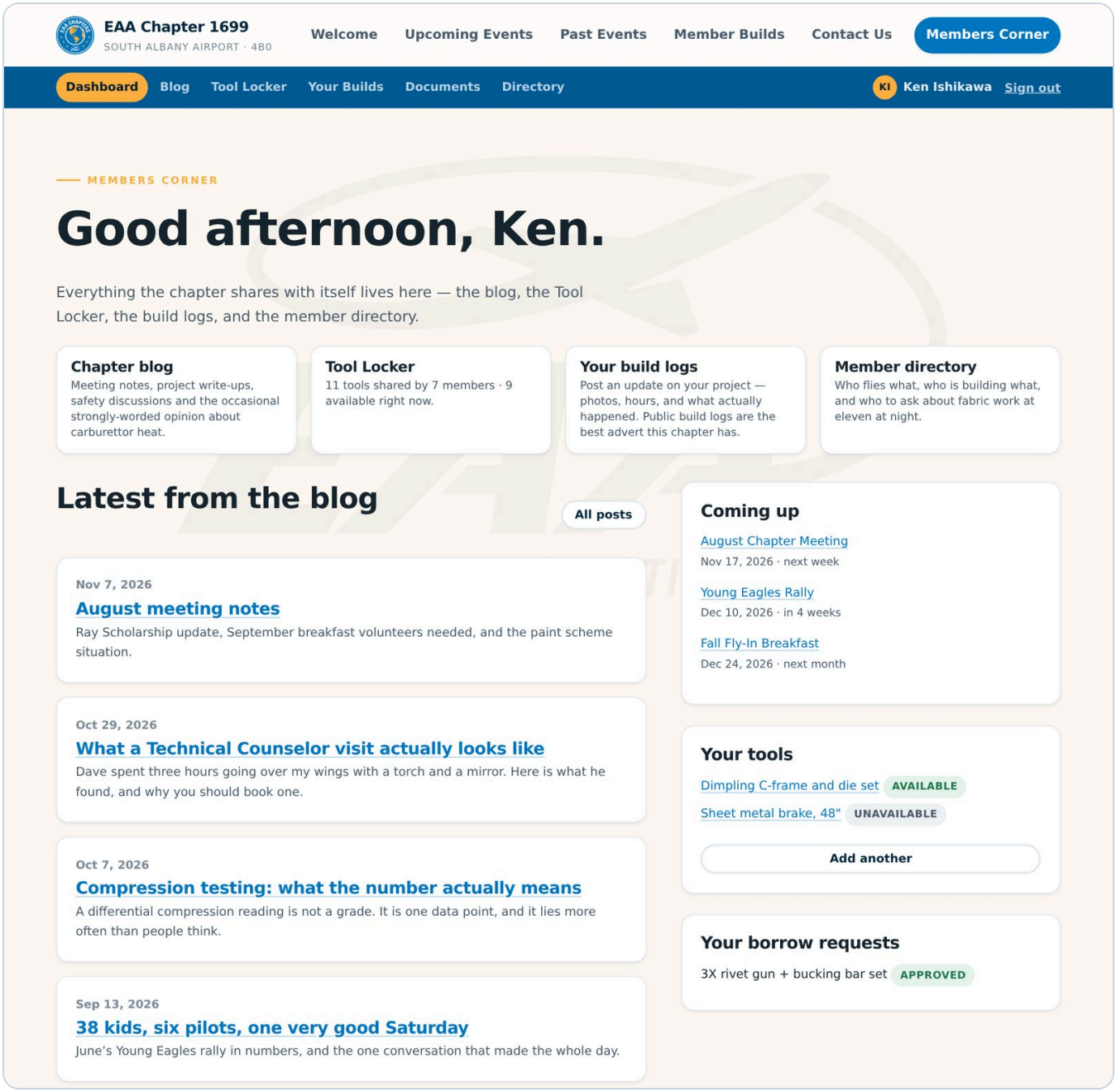
Finding your way around

Once you're signed in, a **blue bar** appears under the main menu whenever you're in the Members Corner. It has everything you need:

Dashboard Blog Tool Locker Your Builds Documents Directory — and your name on the right, which takes you to your account.

A little orange **number badge** on a menu item means something is waiting for you — for example, Tool Locker 1 means somebody wants to borrow one of your tools.

The Dashboard



The dashboard says good morning (or afternoon), then shows the latest blog posts, the next few events, your tools and your borrow requests.

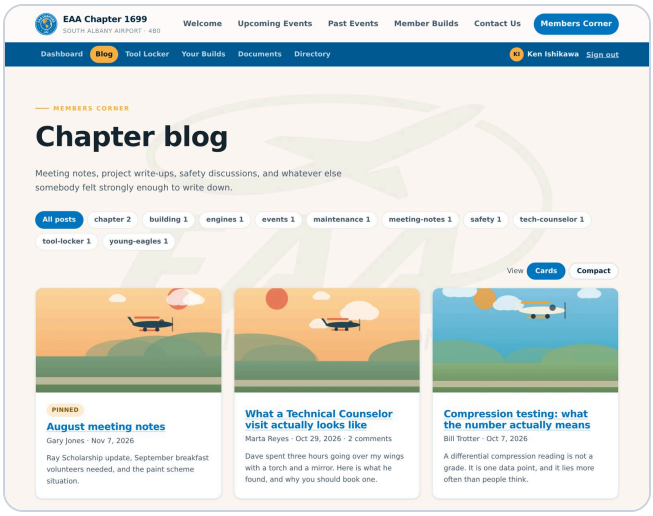
The dashboard is your "what's going on?" page. Down the left are the newest blog posts; down the right are the **next events**, **your tools** (with whether they're available), and any **borrow requests** you've made and where they stand.

The Chapter Blog

The blog is where meeting notes, project write-ups, safety discussions and "strongly worded opinions about carburetor heat" live. Posts are

written by editors, but **everyone can read and comment**.

- Click a **tag** at the top (like *meeting-notes* or *safety*) to see only those posts.
- Switch between **Cards** and **Compact** to see big pictures or a tidy list.
- Posts marked **PINNED** stay at the top — usually the latest meeting notes.
- A post with several photos shows them as a slideshow. Click the arrows to flip through.



The blog, with tags along the top.

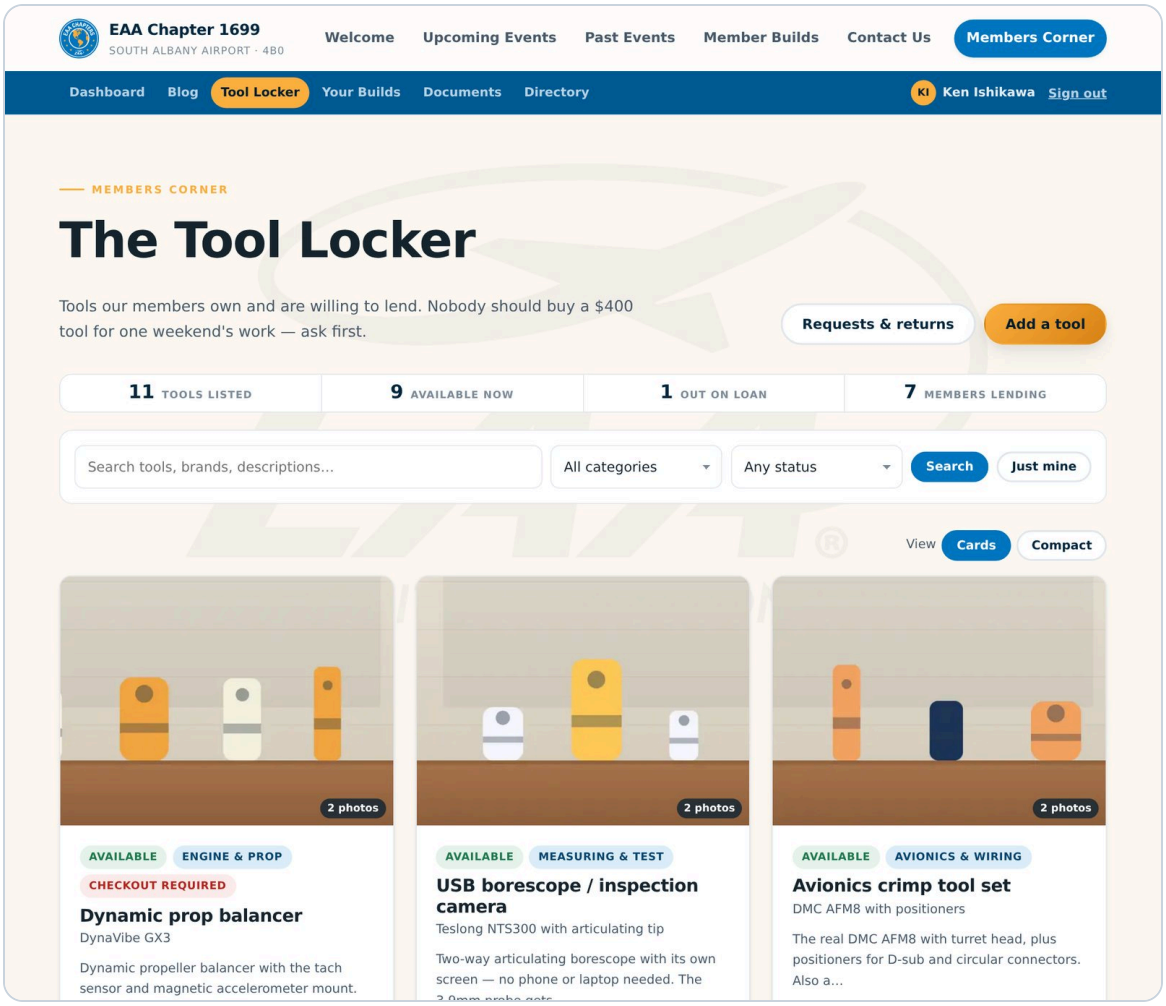
Leaving a comment

Scroll to the bottom of any post, type in the **Add a comment** box and press **Post comment**. Comments are plain text — links and bold won't show up as links and bold. That's on purpose: it keeps anything sneaky out. You can remove your own comment with the **Remove** link under it.

> **✈ Comment etiquette**
>
> The comment box's own advice is "Keep it useful and keep it kind." That's good advice for hangar talk generally. If you're about to type "well, ACTUALLY," maybe save it for the meeting where you can at least buy them a donut first.

The Tool Locker

The Tool Locker is a shared list of tools members own and are happy to lend. The idea is simple: **nobody should buy a $400 tool for one weekend's work.** Ask first.



The Tool Locker. The counters at the top tell you how many tools are listed, available, and out on loan.

Finding a tool

- Type in the **search box** (try "rivet", "torque" or a brand name), pick a **category** and/or a **status**, and press **Search**.
- **Just mine** shows only the tools you've listed.
- Each card shows a status: AVAILABLE, ON LOAN or UNAVAILABLE. A red **Checkout required** tag means the owner wants to show you how to use it first — usually because it's either expensive, pointy, or both.

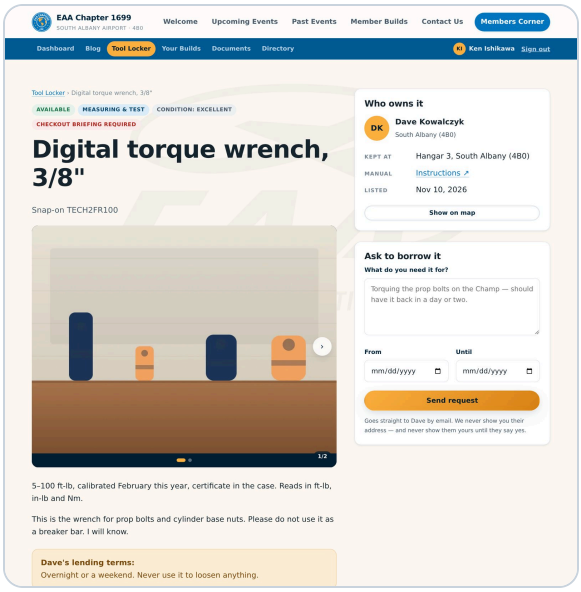
Borrowing a tool

1. Click the tool to open its page. Read the description, the condition and the owner's **lending terms** (in the yellow box).
2. In the **Ask to borrow it** box on the right, say what you need it for and pick the **From** and **Until** dates.
3. Press **Send request**. The owner gets an email.
4. When they **approve**, you'll be able to see each other's contact details so you can arrange the

handover.

5. Check how it's going any time under **Requests & returns** (top of the Tool Locker), where you can also **cancel** a request.

> **✈ Privacy, built in**
>
> The owner doesn't see your email address, and you don't see theirs, *until they say yes*. Nobody gets a surprise phone call about a rivet gun.



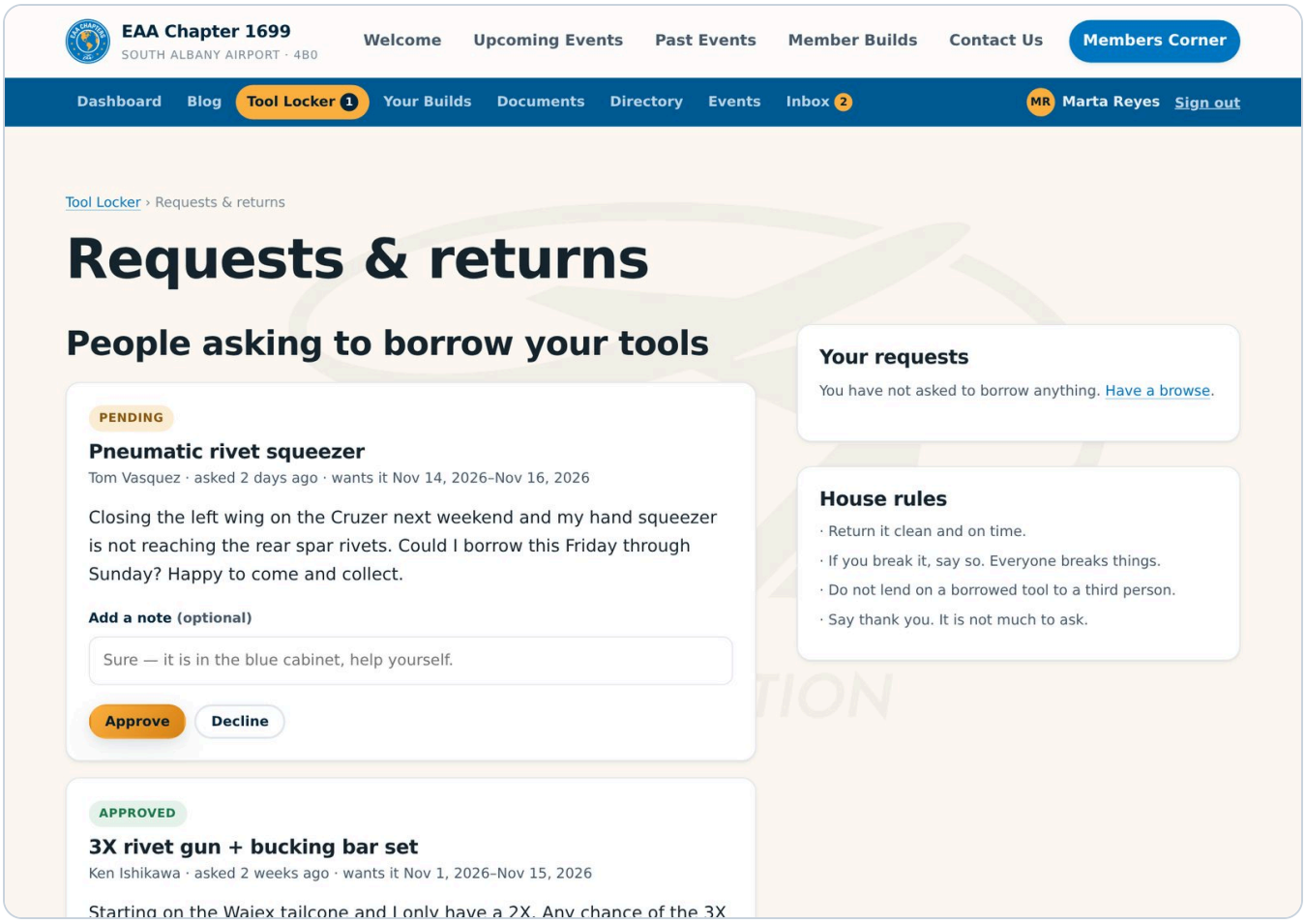
A tool's page. The "Ask to borrow it" form is on the right.

Lending your own tools

To list a tool, click **Add a tool** at the top of the Tool Locker. You'll be asked:

- **What is it?** plus brand, model, category and condition.
- **Availability** — available, on loan or unavailable (handy when it's off being calibrated, or when you need it yourself this month).
- **Where it lives** — "Hangar 3", "my garage in Delmar", "the clubhouse cabinet".
- **Your terms** and an optional **deposit** — e.g. "Overnight or a weekend. Never use it to loosen anything."
- **Photos** — straight off your phone is fine. The site shrinks them and removes the hidden location data your phone adds.

When someone asks to borrow it, you'll get an email and a number badge on **Tool Locker**. Go to **Requests & returns**:



Someone wants to borrow your rivet squeezer. Add a note if you like, then Approve or Decline. When it comes back, press "Mark returned".

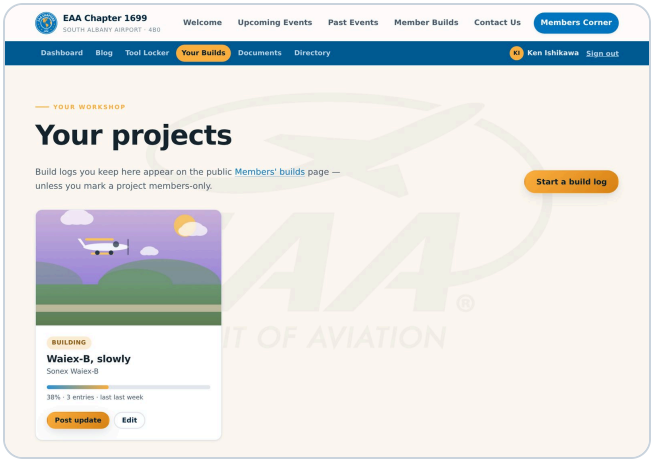
1. Read what they need it for and when. Add a friendly note if you like ("It's in the blue cabinet, help yourself").
2. Press **Approve** or **Decline**. Approving marks the tool **ON LOAN** automatically.
3. When the tool comes home, press **Mark returned**, and it goes back to **AVAILABLE**.

You can edit or delete your listing at any time from the tool's own page with **Edit listing**.

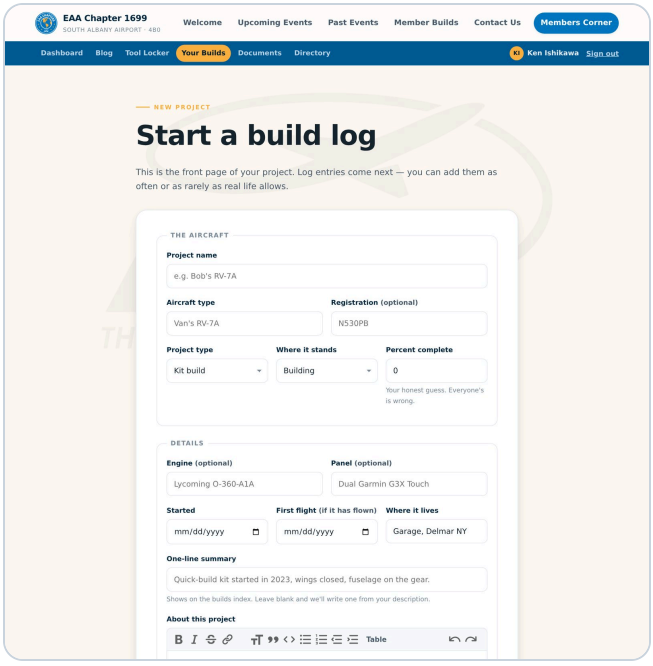
> ☕ **Hangar talk — the House Rules**
> *The Requests page lists four house rules, and every one of them has a story behind it:* ***Return it clean and on time. If you break it, say so — everyone breaks things. Don't lend a borrowed tool on to a third person. Say thank you.*** *Rule three exists because a certain torque wrench once spent a summer touring three counties and came home with a different case. Nobody's quite sure whose.*

Your Builds — keeping a build log

Building, restoring, or even just doing an annual you're proud of? Keep a log. It takes two minutes, and — as the site itself puts it — *future-you will be extremely glad you wrote down what you did to that fuel line.*



"Your Builds" — your projects, with buttons to post an update or edit.



Starting a build log: the project's "front page".

Starting a project

1. Click **Your Builds**, then **Start a build log**.
2. Give it a **name** ("Ken's Waiex" or "Champ — eleven winters"), the **aircraft type**, and if you have one, the N-number.
3. Choose the **project type** and **where it stands** (planning, building, paint, flying…) and take a guess at **percent complete**. The form helpfully notes: *"Your honest guess. Everyone's is wrong."*
4. Add optional details — engine, panel, start date, first flight, where it lives — and one good wide **cover photo**.
5. Choose **who can see it**: **Public** (on the Member Builds page for the world) or **Members only**.

Posting an update

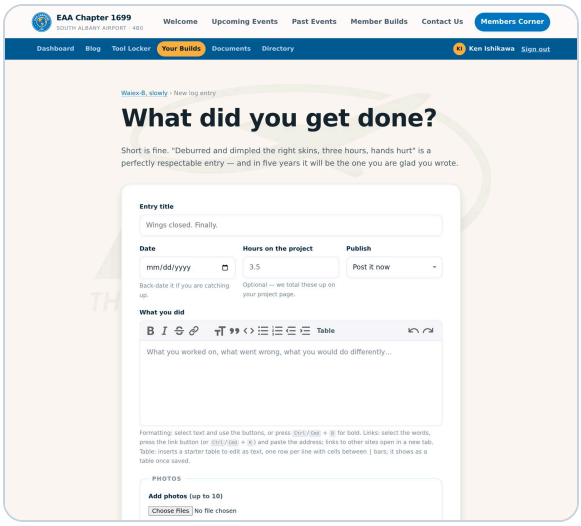
Click **Post update** on your project. Give it a title, a date (you can back-date it if you're catching up), the **hours** you put in, a few words about what you did, and some photos (up to 10).

Short is fine. *"Deburred and dimpled the right skins, three hours, hands hurt"* is a perfectly respectable entry. Hours are added up automatically on your project page, which is either very motivating or quietly alarming.

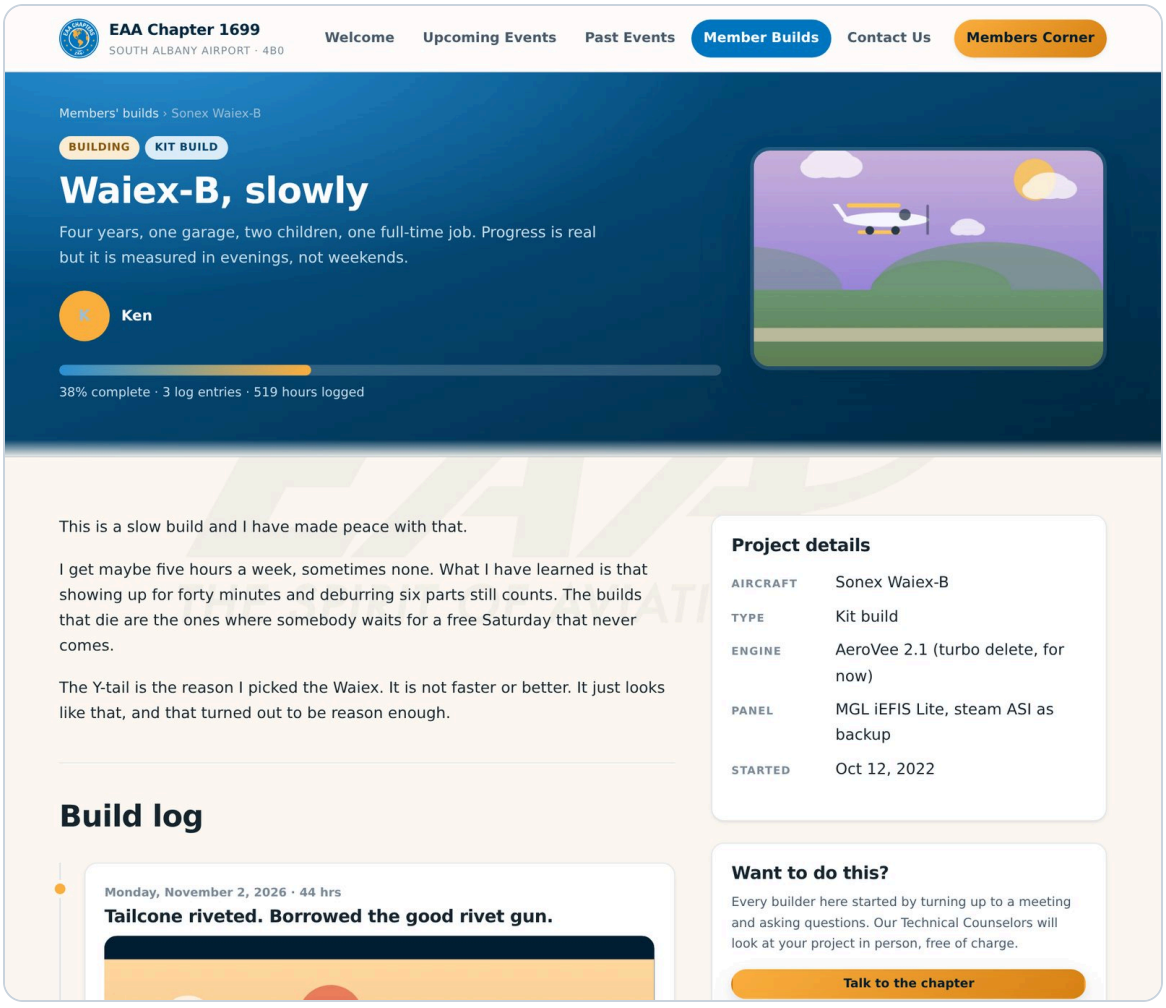
Choose **Post it now**, or **Save as draft** if you want to finish it later.

✈ Cheers!

On the public build page, signed-in members see a **Cheer this on** button. It's the chapter equivalent of a pat on the back. Use it generously. Builders run on cheers and coffee.



"What did you get done?" — a new log entry.



How a build looks to the public: progress bar, project details and a dated build log.

The Member Directory

Who flies what, who's building what, and who to ask about fabric work at eleven at night. Click

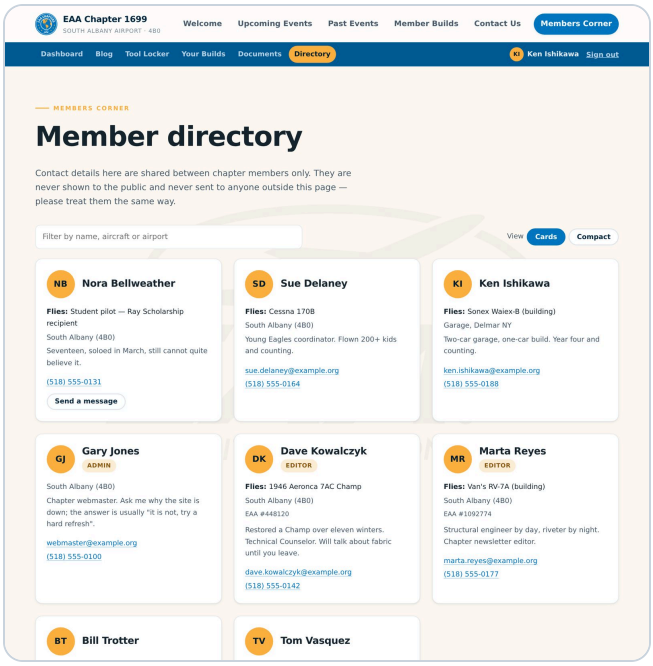
Directory.

- Type in the **Filter members** box to narrow by name, aircraft or airport.
- Switch between **Cards** and **Compact** views.
- Click an email address or phone number to email or call.

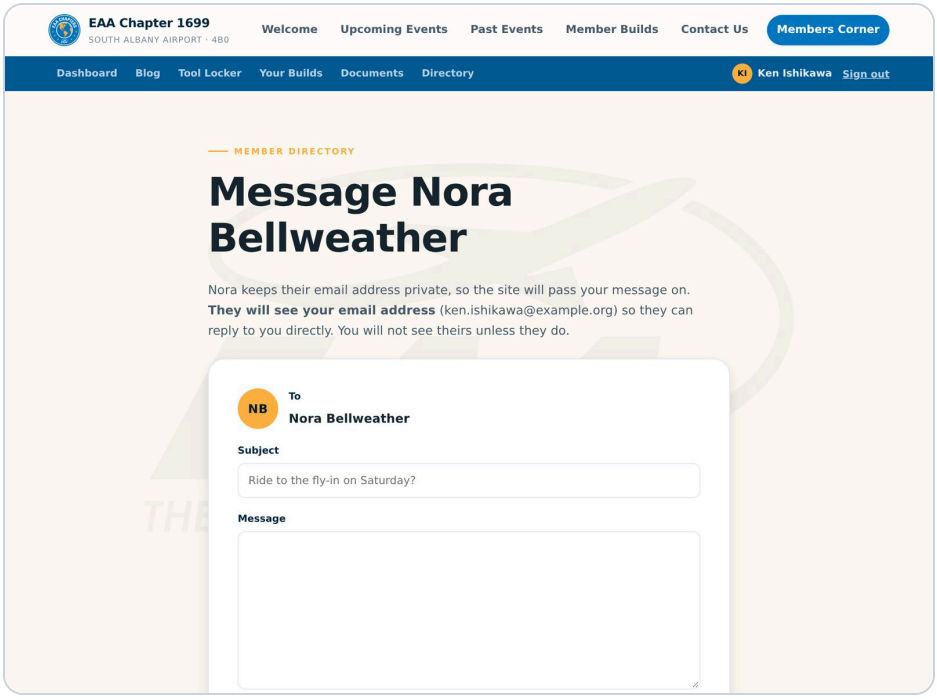
Contact details here are **for members only**. They never appear on the public site. Please treat them the same way — no adding the whole chapter to your cousin's timeshare newsletter.

"Send a message"

Some members prefer to keep their email private. Their card shows a **Send a message** button instead. Your message is delivered by the chapter's email address; they'll see *your* address so they can reply, but you won't see *theirs* unless they do.



The directory. (All addresses and numbers here are fake.)



Messaging a member who keeps their email private.

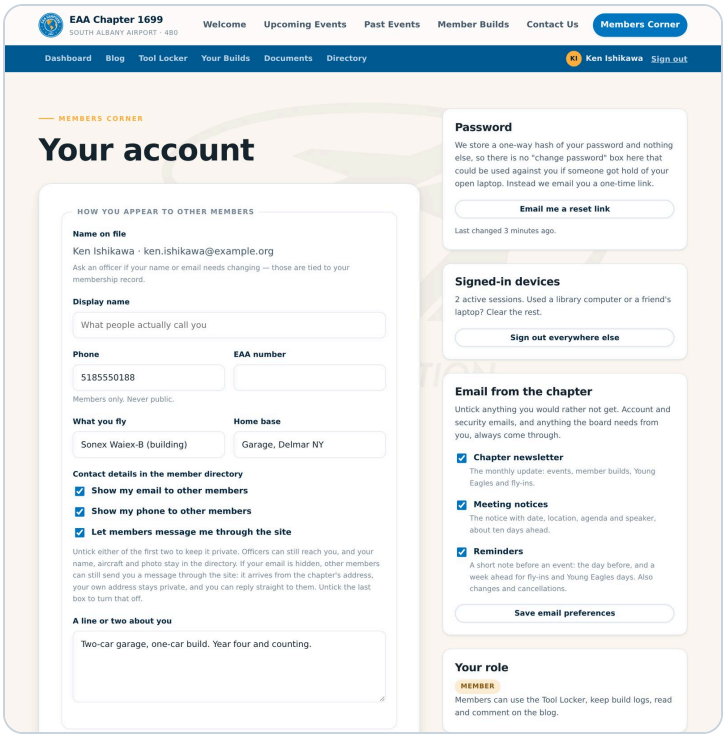
Documents

The **Documents** page holds the chapter's official records — mostly approved **meeting minutes**. Anything here has been reviewed and approved by the board, sorted by year. Click **Download** to open one. If the page says "Nothing published yet," the Secretary hasn't put anything up yet, and you are welcome to gently remind them at the next meeting.

> **✈ For chapter officers**
> The President, Vice President, Secretary and Treasurer also see a **Board workspace** link here, where they draft minutes and approve the meeting notices that go out to members. Holding an office is separate from your website role — see "Chapter offices" in Part 3.

Your Account

Click your **name** at the right end of the blue bar. This is where you control how you appear to other members and what email you get.



Your account page.

> **☕ Hangar talk**
> *One member turned off every email "to cut down on clutter" and then showed up to a Young Eagles rally that had been moved to the rain date. He had the airfield, and the pancakes, entirely to himself. He has since turned **Reminders** back on. We recommend you leave that one ticked.*

Your profile

- **Display name** — what people actually call you. ("Robert" on paper, "Bucky" in the hangar.)
- **Phone, EAA number, what you fly, home base,** and **a line or two about you**.
- **Privacy switches**: show or hide your email and phone in the directory, and allow or block "Send a message".

Press **Save profile**. To change your real name or sign-in email, ask an admin.

Your photo: upload one at the bottom. Square works best.

Password

There's no "change password" box. Press **Email me a reset link** and follow the link. So nobody who finds your laptop open at the FBO can change it.

Used a library computer? **Sign out everywhere else** signs out every other device.

Email from the chapter

Tick or untick: the **chapter newsletter**, **meeting notices**, and event **reminders**. Then **Save email preferences**. Important account and security emails always come through.

PART 2 · EDITORS

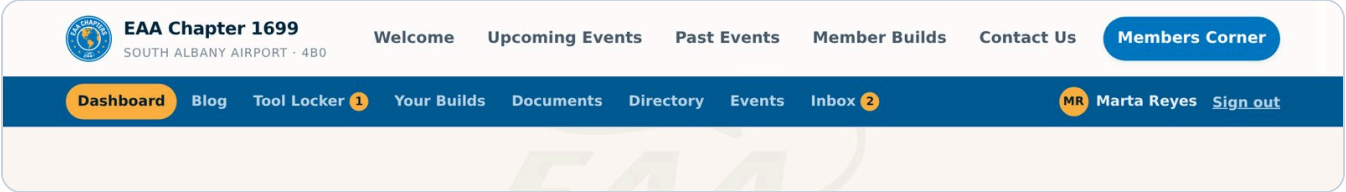
The Right Seat

Editors keep the chapter's news, calendar and inbox in good shape. Everything in Part 1 still applies — this part covers your extra controls.

Editors & admins

Your extra links: Events and Inbox

As an editor, two extra links appear on the blue bar, right after **Directory**:



An editor's blue bar. Events and Inbox sit right after Directory, and the "2" next to Inbox means two messages are waiting.

- **Events**: add and manage the chapter calendar.
- **Inbox**: messages from the public Contact Us form. A little orange number next to it tells you how many still need a reply.

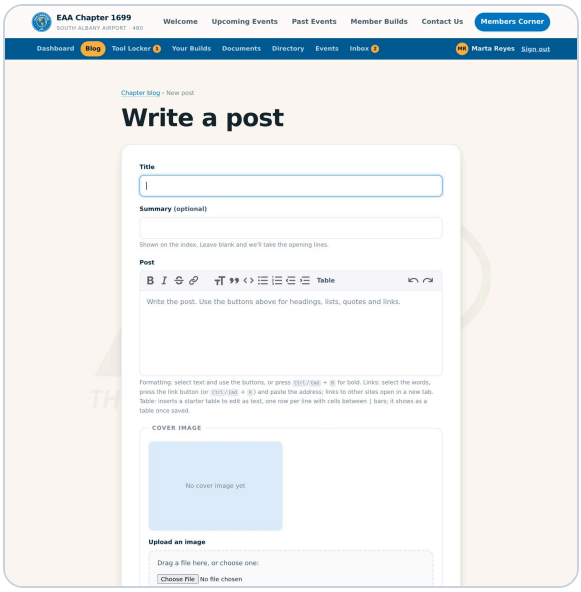
Writing blog posts happens on the **Blog** page itself, using the **Write a post** button that editors see.

> **✈ Admins reading this part**
>
> You have the same two pages, but they're tucked inside your orange **☰ Admin tools** menu with the rest of your admin pages. Wherever this part says "click **Events**" or "click **Inbox**", open that menu first.

Writing a blog post

1. Go to **Blog** and click **Write a post**.
2. Add a **Title**. The **Summary** is optional — leave it blank and the first few lines are used.
3. Write the post in the big box. It works like a simple word processor: select some words and click **B** for bold, *I* for italic, the chain-link for a link, and so on. The **Table** button inserts a starter table.
4. Add a **cover image** (with a short description of what's in it, for members who use screen readers).

5. Add more **photos** — up to 20. They appear as a slideshow under the text. Drag them to reorder, or pick a different one as the cover.
6. Add a few **tags**. Start typing and the site suggests tags already in use, so we don't end up with *safety*, *Safety* and *safty*.
7. Tick **Pinned** to keep it at the top of the blog (great for the latest meeting notes).
8. Publish it, or save it as a **draft** to finish later. Drafts are marked "not visible to members yet."



The "Write a post" page.

> **✈ Editing, and the safety net**
>
> Editors can edit **any** post, not only their own — open the post and click **Edit post**. Every save keeps the previous version, and the edit page shows a **revision history**, so nothing is ever truly lost. Handy shortcuts: **Ctrl+B** (or **Cmd+B** on a Mac) for bold, and **Ctrl/Cmd+K** for a link.

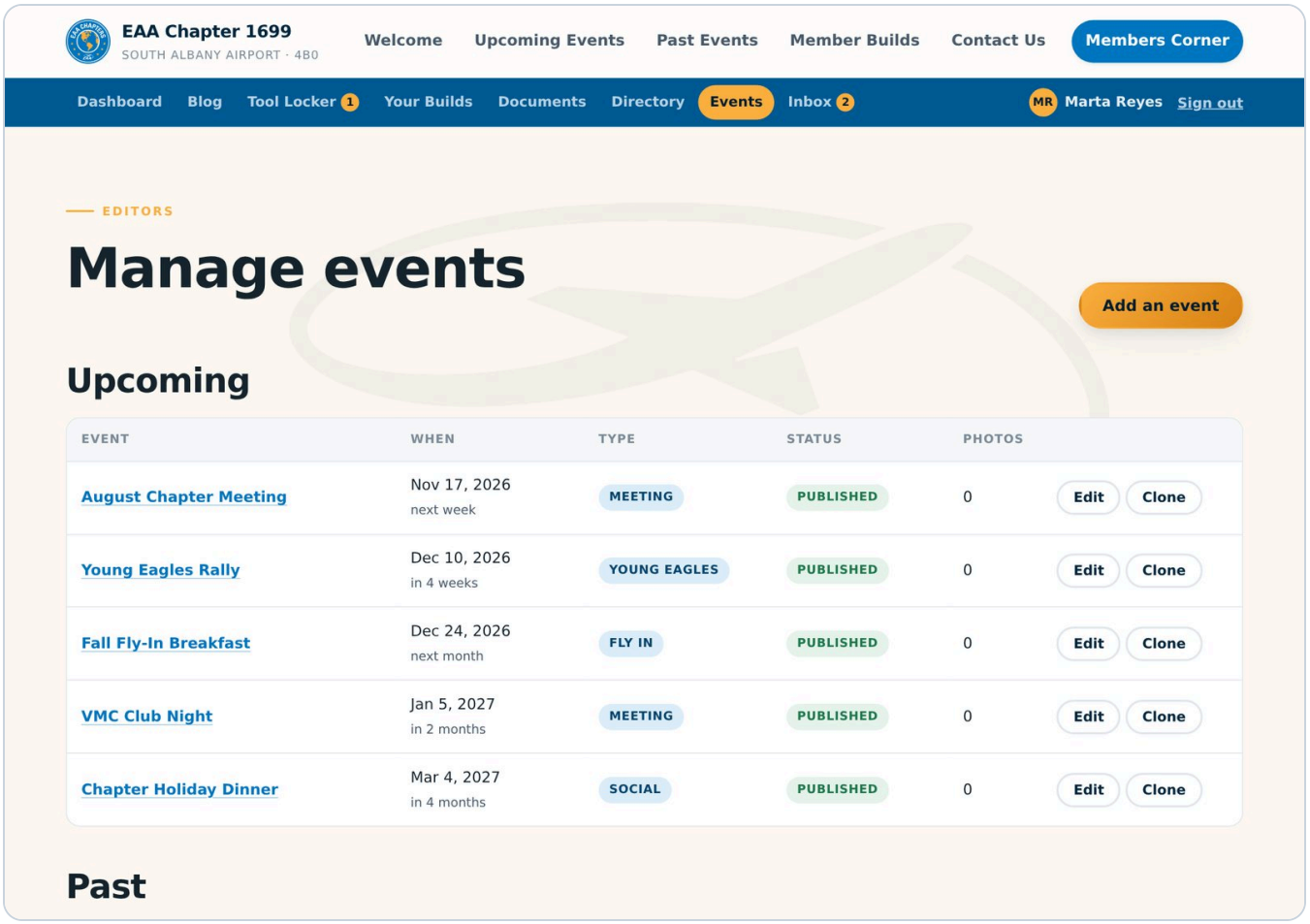
Tidying up comments

As an editor you'll see a **Remove** link under every comment. Use it sparingly — for spam, the occasional heated exchange, or the member who replied "test" four times. Most disagreements are better settled over coffee.

> **☕ Hangar talk**
>
> *Our newsletter editor once wrote a beautiful 1,200-word meeting recap, then accidentally deleted half of it while trying to add a photo. One click on an older version in the revision history and it was all back. She now describes the revision list as "the parachute I didn't know I'd packed."*

Running the events calendar

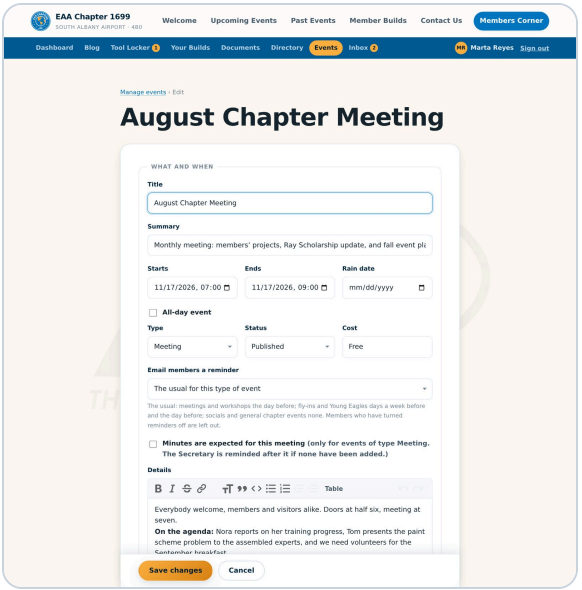
Click **Events** in the blue bar. You'll see two tables: **Upcoming** and **Past**, each showing the date, type, status and number of photos.



Manage events. Every event has Edit and Clone buttons.

Adding an event

1. Click **Add an event** — or, much faster, find last year's version and press **Clone**. Cloning copies everything except last time's write-up, head-count and photos. **Check the dates** before saving!
2. **What and when:** title, a one-line summary, start and end times, an optional **rain date**, or tick **All-day event**.
3. Pick a **Type** (meeting, fly-in, Young Eagles, workshop, social…), a **Status** (Published, Draft or Cancelled) and the **Cost**.
4. **Email members a reminder:** leave it on "The usual" unless you have a reason not to (see the tip below).
5. Fill in **Where** (the address, so the Directions button works) and **Who to ask**.
6. Upload a **poster** — landscape works best, about 1600 × 900 pixels. Keep any writing away from the



Editing an event.

edges.

7. Press **Save changes**.

> **✈ What "The usual" reminders means**
>
> **Meetings and workshops:** a reminder email the day before. **Fly-ins and Young Eagles days:** a week before *and* the day before. **Socials:** no reminder. Members who have switched reminders off aren't bothered. For meetings, you can also tick **Minutes are expected** so the Secretary gets a nudge afterwards.

When plans change (it's aviation — they will)

At the bottom of an event's edit page is **Tell members about a change**. Use it for a new time or place, or a weather cancellation:

1. First, update the event's date or place at the top of the page, so the details in the email are right. If it's cancelled, set its status to **Cancelled** (that stops any further reminders).
2. Choose **A change** or **It is cancelled**, and write what members need to know in plain words.
3. Send yourself a **preview** first. Then send it for real.

After the event

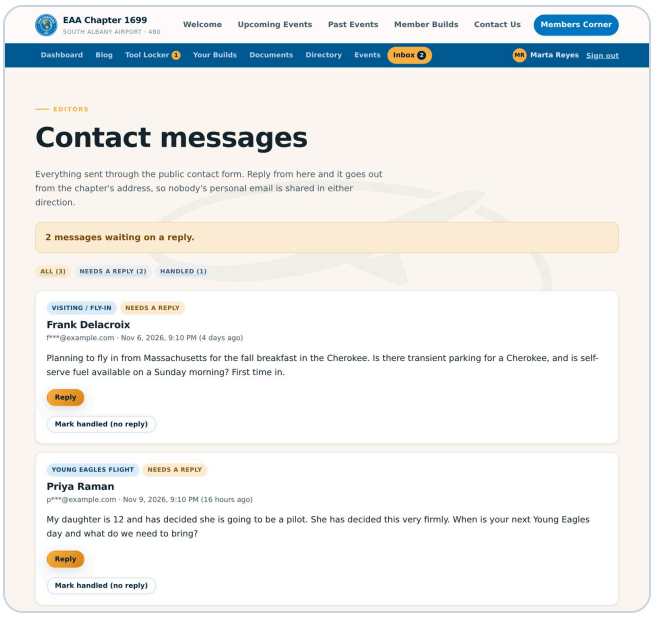
Go back and edit the event once it's over. In the **Afterwards** section add **roughly how many came**, a short **write-up**, and upload the **event photos**. They'll appear on the public **Past Events** page — the chapter's scrapbook, and its best advertisement.

> **☕ Hangar talk**
>
> *The Fall Fly-In Breakfast has been "cloned" from the year before for so many years that the event is effectively a family heirloom. The only thing that ever changes is the date — which is precisely the thing everyone forgets to change. Check the dates. Then check them again.*

The Contact Us inbox

Messages from the public **Contact Us** form arrive here: click **Inbox** in the blue bar. The number next to it tells you how many are waiting.

- Use the filters at the top — **All**, **Needs a reply**, **Handled**.
- Press **Reply** to answer. Your reply goes out from the **chapter's** email address, signed with your first name only, with their message quoted underneath. Neither side's personal email is shared.
- Sending a reply marks the message **handled** automatically. No reply needed? Press **Mark handled (no reply)**.



The inbox. Visitors' addresses are partly hidden here, too.

✈ Answer within a day or two

Most messages are from people asking "can I just turn up?" (Yes!) or "when is the next Young Eagles day?" A quick, friendly reply is often the difference between a new member and a missed one.

PART 3 · ADMINISTRATORS

Pilot in Command

Admins let new people in, hand out the right keys, and keep an eye on the engine gauges. Everything in Parts 1 and 2 applies to you as well.

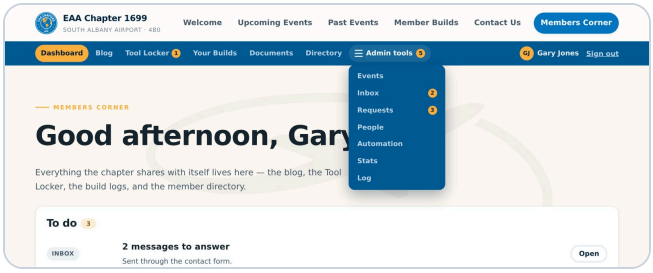
Admins only

Your Admin tools menu

Only admins have the orange **☰ Admin tools** button at the end of the blue bar. Click it to open your menu:

- **Events** and **Inbox**: the same pages editors use. Editors have them as links on the blue bar; yours live in this menu.
- **Requests** — people asking to join.
- **People** — every member account.
- **Automation** — emails the site sends on its own.
- **Stats** — how the site is being used.
- **Log** — the activity log and the outgoing mail queue.

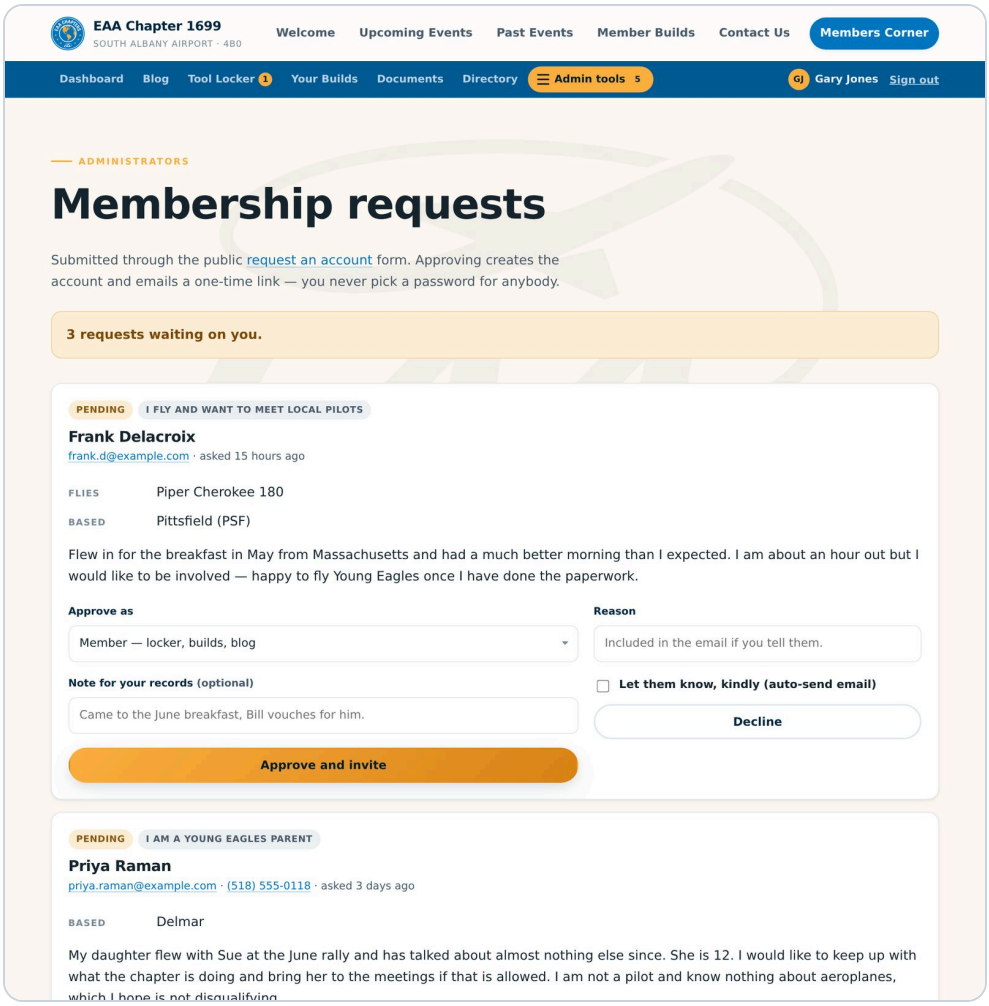
Admins can also edit or remove *anyone's* tool listing or build log, should the need arise (e.g. someone moves away and leaves a "ghost" drill press in the Locker).



Admins see the whole menu, with numbers for anything waiting.

Membership requests

When someone fills in the public "Request an account" form, it lands here: **☰ Admin tools** → **Requests**. Nothing exists in the members' area until you approve — no account, no directory entry, nothing.



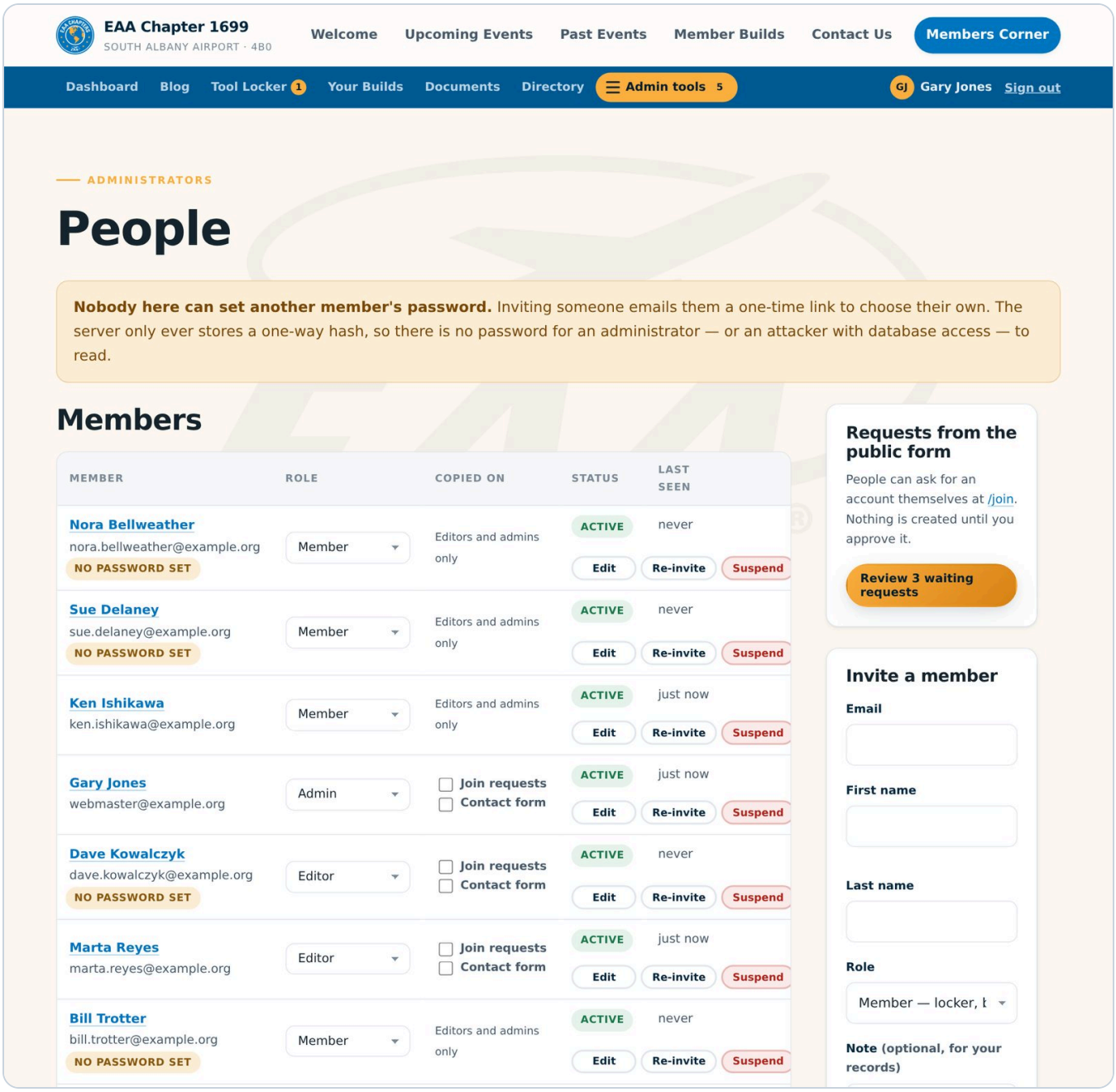
A membership request: who they are, what they fly, and in their own words why they'd like to join.

1. Read the request. Do we know them? Did they come to a breakfast? Does someone vouch for them?
2. **To approve:** choose the role (almost always **Member**), optionally add a **note for your records** ("Came to the June breakfast, Bill vouches for him"), and press **Approve and invite**. The account is created and an invitation email goes out.
3. **To decline:** optionally type a reason, tick **Let them know, kindly** if you want them emailed, and press **Decline**.

> **✈ Behind the scenes**
>
> The form protects itself. If someone who's already a member applies again, or the same person applies twice, they quietly don't reach your queue — and the form looks identical to them either way, so nobody can use it to test who's a member.

People

☰ Admin tools → **People** lists every account. For each person you'll see their role, status and when they were last seen.



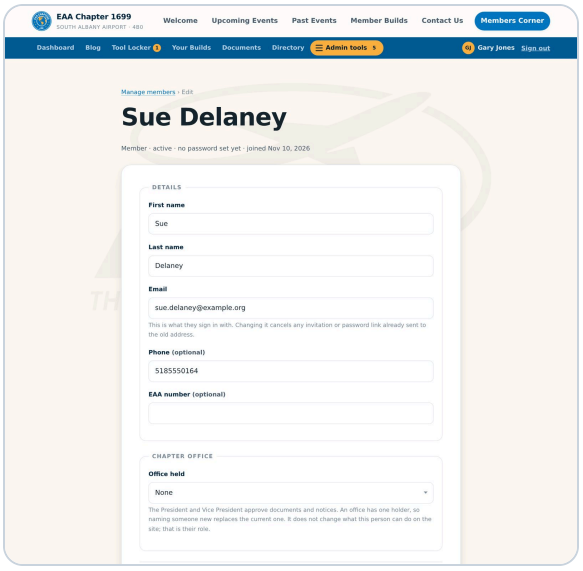
The People page. "No password set" means they haven't used their invitation yet.

You want to…	Do this
Invite someone directly	Fill in **Invite a member** on the right (email, first and last name, role) and press **Send invitation**. They get the same one-time link as an approved request.
Make someone an editor (or admin)	Change the **Role** drop-down on their row. It takes effect immediately — no need for them to sign out.
Resend an invitation	Press **Re-invite**. Useful when the email went to spam or the 14 days ran out. Look for **NO PASSWORD SET**.
Fix a name, email or phone	Press **Edit**. Changing someone's email changes what they sign in with, and cancels any links sent to the old address.
Temporarily block sign-in	Press **Suspend**. They're signed out at once, but nothing is deleted. The button then reads **Reactivate** — press it to let them back in.
Get copies of chapter mail	Tick **Join requests** and/or **Contact form** in the **Copied on** column for editors and admins who should get an email when those arrive.

Editing a member, and removing one

The **Edit** page lets you fix their details and set a **Chapter office** (see below). At the very bottom is a red **Remove this member** box. It shows exactly what will be deleted — their tools, builds, borrow requests and comments (their blog posts stay, without an author) — and makes you tick **I understand this cannot be undone**.

> **⚠ Suspend first, remove later**
>
> Removing is permanent. If in doubt, **Suspend**: it blocks sign-in but keeps everything. You can always remove later; you can never un-remove.



Editing a member's details and chapter office.

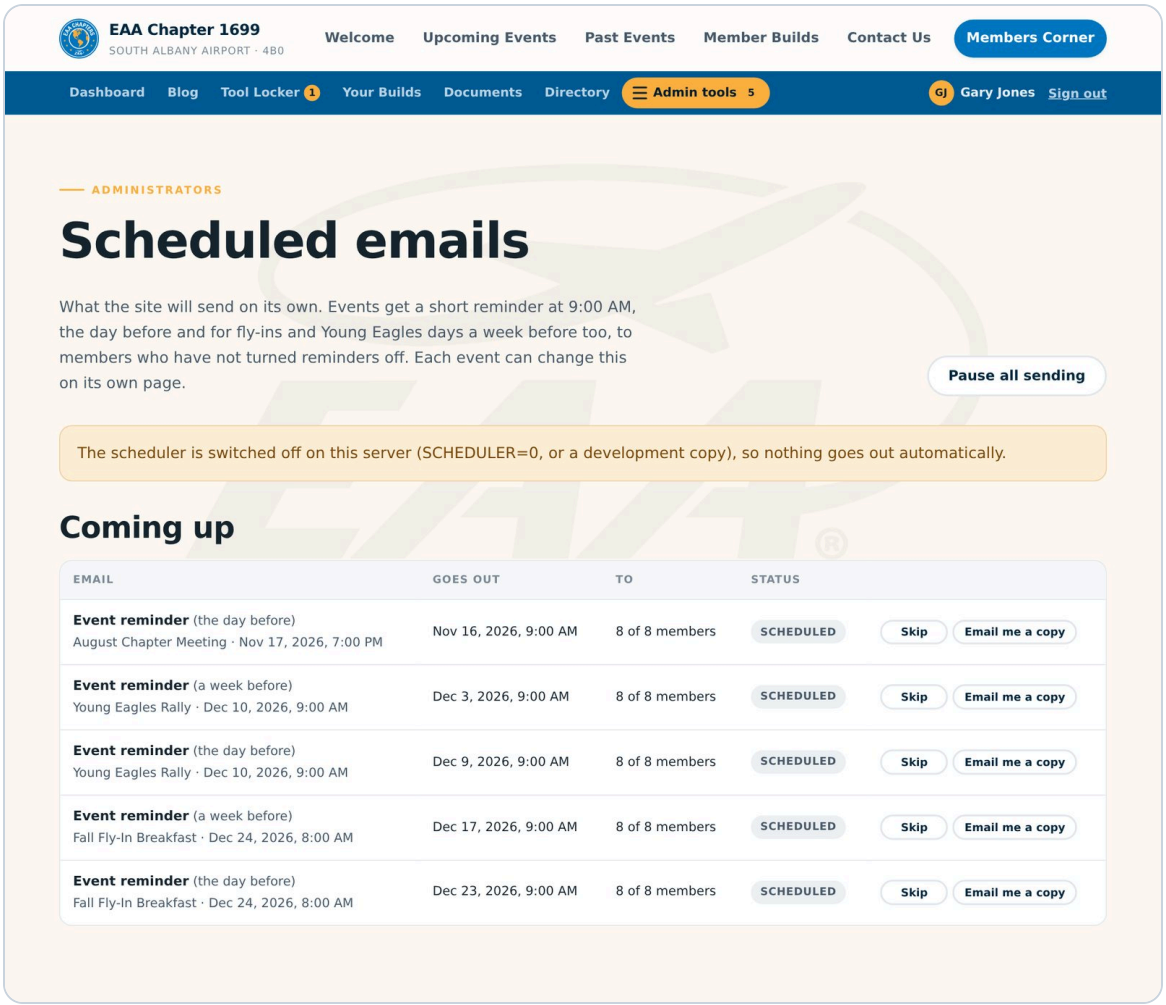
Chapter offices

The **Office held** drop-down names the chapter's President, Vice President, Secretary or Treasurer. An office is *separate* from the website role: it doesn't change what someone can do on the site, but it opens the board's document workspace. The President and VP approve documents and meeting notices. Each office has one holder, so naming a new Secretary replaces the old one.

> **✈ You can't lock the hangar from the inside**
> The site won't let the **last remaining admin** be demoted or suspended, and you can't remove your own account. So the chapter can never accidentally lock itself out. (We've all seen the guy who locked his keys in the plane. The website has learned from him.)

Automation — emails the site sends by itself

☰ Admin tools → **Automation** shows every email the site is planning to send on its own: event reminders and meeting notices, with when they'll go out and how many members will get them.



Scheduled emails: what's coming up, and to how many people.

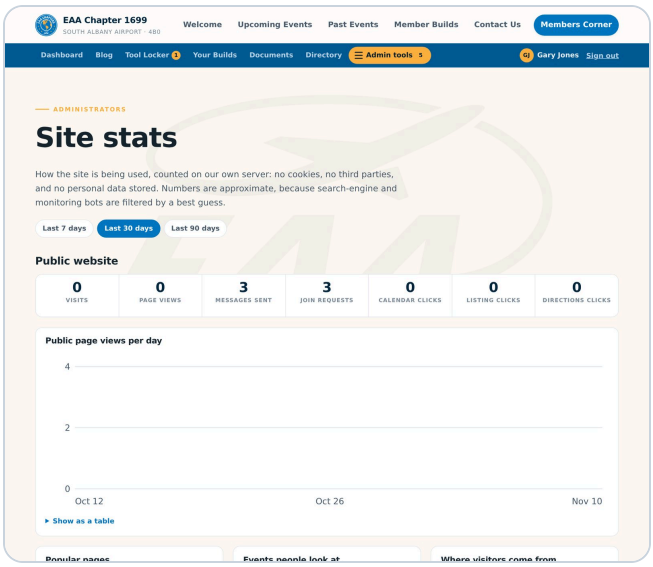
- **Skip** — don't send this one (e.g. the event changed and you've already told everyone). **Restore** undoes it.
- **Email me a copy** — sends a test copy to you, so you can see exactly what members will get.
- **Pause all sending** — the big red-handle. Nothing goes out until someone resumes it.
- **Meeting notices** are drafted about two weeks before a meeting and sent about ten days before — but *only* after the President, VP or Secretary approves them. An unapproved notice is never sent.

> **☕ Hangar talk**
>
> *A Young Eagles rally got weathered out on a Friday afternoon. The event was marked cancelled, a "Tell members about a change" email went out, and the Saturday-morning reminder was skipped — all in about three minutes, from a phone, in a hangar, while it was raining sideways. That is precisely what this page is for.*

Site stats

☰ Admin tools → **Stats** shows how the site is being used over the last 7, 30 or 90 days — visits, popular pages, which events people look at, where visitors come from, and whether visits turn into contact messages or join requests.

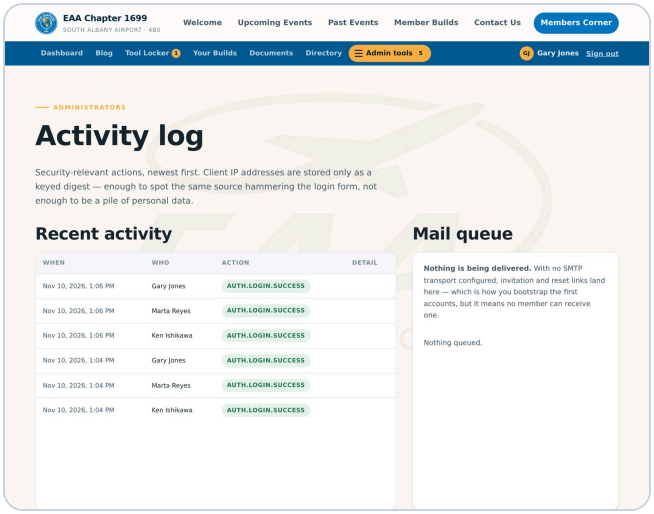
It's counted on our own server: **no cookies, no outside trackers, no personal data**. Members and officers are counted separately, so your own testing doesn't skew the numbers.



Site stats (our practice copy has had very few visitors — a quiet Tuesday at the airport).

> **✈ Poster & QR tags**
>
> Putting up a flyer at the diner? Add a tag to the printed link or QR code (the Stats page shows the format), using a different word for each flyer — *poster*, *flyer*, *facebook*. Then you'll know which one actually brought people in. Spoiler: it's usually the diner.

Activity log & mail queue



The activity log (left) and mail queue (right).

☰ Admin tools → **Log** is the logbook of the website.

- **Recent activity** lists important actions, newest first — sign-ins, role changes, invitations, deletions. Something odd? Look here first.
- **Mail queue** shows emails going out. If one couldn't be delivered (a typo'd address, say) it shows here: fix the cause and press **Retry now**, or **Dismiss** it if the address was never going to work.
- **Site info** at the bottom is for the technically minded — memory, disk and backups.

PART 4 · EVERYONE

It's Your Hangar Too

Look at the very bottom of any page: *"Built by members, for members."* That isn't a slogan. This website belongs to you, and it gets better every time somebody speaks up.

Every seat

Got an idea? We want to hear it.

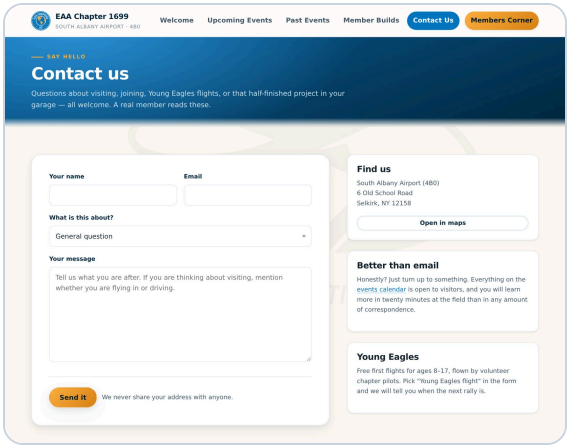
Nobody knows what this site should do better than the people using it, and that's you. Wish the Tool Locker had a category for your oddball tool? Think the events page should show something it doesn't? Found a button that made you scratch your head? That isn't being picky. That's exactly the feedback that makes the site better for everyone.

No idea is too small, and no question is too basic. If something confused you, it has confused somebody else too. They just didn't say so.

Three easy ways to tell us

1. Use "Contact Us"

It's on the menu at the top of every page, and it works whether or not you're signed in. Pick a topic, type your thought, and press **Send it**. It lands in the editors' inbox, and a real person will write back.



The Contact Us form. Ideas, questions and complaints all welcome.

2. Find one of us in the Directory

Open the **Directory** and look for an orange **ADMIN** or **EDITOR** tag on a member's card. Those are the people who can change things on the site. Email them, call them, or use **Send a message**. They'd genuinely like to hear from you.



Orange tags show who can make changes (demo members, fake contact details).

3. Grab us at a meeting

Ideas scribbled on a napkin over pancakes are gladly accepted. (Syrup stains may delay processing.)

Found something broken? Tell us. Please!

If something doesn't work, you aren't doing it wrong. You've found something we need to fix, and you'll be doing everyone a favor by mentioning it. The more of these you can include, the faster it gets fixed:

- **Which page** you were on
- **What you clicked** or typed
- **What you expected**, and **what happened** instead
- Whether you were on a **phone, tablet or computer**
- A **screenshot**, if you can manage one

> ✈ **Think of it as a squawk sheet**
>
> "It's broken" is a fine start. But "the **Send request** button on the torque wrench page did nothing on my iPhone" is the kind of squawk that gets fixed by Saturday. Same as with an airplane: the better the write-up, the quicker the fix.

More ways to make it yours

- **List a tool** in the Tool Locker. Even one helps. That's how a shared tool crib gets started.
- **Start a build log**, even for a restoration, an annual or a panel upgrade. Somebody out there is about to start the same job and would love to see how you did it.
- **Comment on blog posts.** A one-line "great write-up, thanks" makes an editor's whole week.
- **Got something to say?** A tip, a trip report, a lesson learned the hard way? Send it to an editor and they'll help you turn it into a blog post.
- **Took photos at an event?** Pass them to an editor for the Past Events scrapbook.
- **Want a bigger hand on the controls?** Ask an admin about becoming an editor. The right seat is always open to volunteers.

> ☕ **Hangar talk**
>
> *Plenty of this site started as an offhand comment. A member mentions over coffee that she'd like to keep her email private but still be reachable, and a few weeks later the directory grows a "Send a message" button. An editor grumbles that two links are hiding behind a menu, and the next week they're right there on the bar. That's how this site grows, and your offhand comment could be next.*

> ✈ **Go ahead and explore. You won't break it.**
>
> Not sure whether you're allowed to click something? Click it. The site asks "are you sure?" before anything permanent, and the buttons that could cause real trouble are only shown to the people who are meant to use them. Poking around is how you find the good stuff, and the good ideas.

APPENDIX

Checklists

Every good airplane has a checklist. So does every good website guide.

Keep in the seat-back pocket

Who can do what

Task	Member	Editor	Admin
Read the blog and comment	✔	✔	✔
List, lend and borrow tools	✔	✔	✔
Keep your own build log	✔	✔	✔
Use the directory and send messages	✔	✔	✔
Read published chapter documents	✔	✔	✔
Write, edit and pin blog posts	—	✔	✔
Remove anyone's comments	—	✔	✔
Add, edit, clone and cancel events	—	✔	✔
Answer the Contact Us inbox	—	✔	✔
Approve or decline membership requests	—	—	✔
Invite, re-invite, change roles, suspend, remove	—	—	✔
Name chapter officers	—	—	✔
Edit or remove anyone's tools and builds	—	—	✔
Automation, Stats and the Log	—	—	✔

Chapter officers (President, VP, Secretary, Treasurer) additionally get the Board workspace under Documents, whatever their website role.

Troubleshooting — "squawks"

"I never got my invitation / reset email."

Check your spam or junk folder first — it'll be from the chapter's address. Still nothing? Ask an admin to press **Re-invite** (for invitations) or use **Forgotten it?** again (for passwords). Admins can check the **Mail queue** on the Log page to see whether it went out.

"The link says it has expired."

Password links last one hour; invitations last 14 days. Just ask for a fresh one. Links only work once, too — if you clicked it already, request a new one.

"It says my account is locked."

Too many wrong passwords. Wait 15 minutes, or use **Forgotten it?** to set a new password.

"I got signed out in the middle of something."

Sessions last about 12 hours. Sign in again and you'll be taken back to where you were heading.

"It says 'You do not have access to that area.'"

That page belongs to a higher seat — editors or admins. If you think you should have access, ask an admin to check your role.

"My photo upload didn't work."

Photos need to be under about 12 MB each. Phone photos are almost always fine; giant camera files sometimes aren't. Try one at a time, or send a smaller copy.

"The page looks weird or old."

In the words of our webmaster's own directory profile: *"Ask me why the site is down; the answer is usually 'it is not, try a hard refresh'."* Press **Ctrl+F5** (Windows) or **Cmd+Shift+R** (Mac).

"I can't see the Tool Locker / Directory / Blog."

Those are in the blue Members Corner bar, which only appears once you're signed in and inside the Members Corner. Click the orange **Members Corner** button first.

Hangar talk to plain English

On the website	What it means
Members Corner	The members-only part of the site. You must be signed in.
Role	Your seat: Member, Editor or Admin. Decides which buttons you see.
Office	A chapter board position (President etc.). Separate from your role.
Draft	Saved but not shown to anyone yet. A blog post or build entry in the hangar, not on the ramp.
Published	Live and visible.
Pinned	Stuck to the top of the blog list.
Clone	Copy an existing event to make a new one quickly.
Suspend	Stop someone signing in, without deleting anything.
Invitation link	The one-time email link a new member uses to choose their password.
Badge	The little orange number on a menu item: "something here needs you."
Hard refresh	Make your browser fetch a fresh copy of the page. Fixes more than you'd think.

About the pictures. Every screenshot in this guide comes from a practice copy of the site filled with made-up demo members (Dave, Marta, Ken, Sue, Tom, Bill and Nora). All email addresses and phone numbers shown are fake (...@*example.org* and *555* numbers). The stories are made up to illustrate how things work, and any resemblance to an actual hangar is entirely deliberate.

That's it. Blue skies.

Questions? Ideas? Something broken? Use **Contact Us**, or find anyone with an orange Editor or Admin tag in the **Directory**.

It's your hangar too, so tell us how to make it better.